Bulletin

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GOVERNANCE · FINANCE · ICT INFRASTRUCTURE · DPI · TECHNOLOGY · CAPACITY · INCLUSION · DATA · GEOPOLITICS

Governance

Strategies, plans and policies

- **وزير الاتصالات: السيادة الرقمية تقوم على 5 محاور تشمل البنية التحتية والأمن السيبرانى والذكاء الاصطناعى** — Youm7, 20 October 2026 EGYPT

  Egypt's Communications and IT Minister Raafat Hindy presented a digital sovereignty strategy with five pillars at the Digital Egypt session of Egypt Forum 2026, reported on 20 October 2026. The pillars are sovereign digital infrastructure, cybersecurity, AI development, data protection and technology talent. He defined sovereignty as state control over its own infrastructure, data and services, not isolation. *Also under Digital sovereignty, Cybersecurity and AI.*

- **World Bank Group Launches First Digital Strategy to Expand Access and Create Jobs** — World Bank Group, 20 October 2026 GLOBAL AFRICA

  The World Bank Group launched its first digital strategy in Seoul on 20 October 2026, with four priorities: connectivity, affordable devices and data, digital services and skills, and AI readiness. It also announced an AI Infrastructure and Readiness Initiative that gives emerging-market governments shared pay-as-you-go GPU capacity, starting with Africa and Latin America, with Cassava Technologies and NVIDIA as knowledge partners. *Also under Connectivity, Digital divides and AI.*

- **UCC Tightens Licensing Rules for Wi-Fi Hotspot Operators** — Nile Post, 20 October 2026 UGANDA

  The Uganda Communications Commission said on 20 October 2026 that commercial Wi-Fi hotspot resellers must be licensed and must stop reselling home internet packages. Its seven-day deadline for unlicensed operators ended on 19 October 2026. It will open a registration system by service category and set up a joint committee with government, security agencies and seven hotspot operators. *Also under Connectivity.*

- **Sénégal : une nouvelle instance pour harmoniser les projets numériques de l'État** — wearetech.africa, 20 October 2026 SENEGAL

  Senegal's Prime Minister installed the Comité de gouvernance du numérique (GouVNum) on 16 October 2026 to coordinate state digital projects and rationalise digital spending. The telecoms and digital ministry acts as its permanent secretariat. The 2034 targets under the New Deal technologique are 90% of administrative procedures dematerialised and a digital identity for 90% of citizens. *Also under Other GovTech and e-Gov.*

- **Présidence de la République : un comité national du Numérique créé** — La Nation, 20 October 2026 BENIN

Benin created a National Digital Committee under the President of the Republic by decree n° 2026-579 of 2 September 2026, reported on 20 October 2026. The head of state chairs it and it meets quarterly. It tracks digital projects through a quarterly dashboard from a permanent secretariat, and gives prior opinions on structuring digital projects and on technology partnerships that could affect national digital sovereignty. *Also under Digital sovereignty and Cybersecurity.*

- **Mozambique: Government plans to track and monitor businesses on digital platforms** — Club of Mozambique, 20 October 2026 MOZAMBIQUE

  Mozambique's government will track and monitor businesses operating on digital platforms, including online credit providers, under its recently approved decree on electronic transactions and e-commerce. The Council of Ministers' spokesperson said so on 20 October 2026. The Digital Transformation Agency is among the bodies that will supervise operators. *Also under Legislation and regulation.*

- **Autorité de Régulation de la communication et du traitement des données à caractère personnel : W. Louis Modeste Ouédraogo nommé président** — leFaso.net, 20 October 2026 BURKINA FASO

  Burkina Faso appointed W. Louis Modeste Ouédraogo, previously president of the Conseil supérieur de la communication, to head the new regulator formed by merging that council with the data-protection commission CIL. The decree is dated 16 October 2026. *Also under Data protection.*

Legislation and regulation

- **Mozambique: Government plans to track and monitor businesses on digital platforms** — Club of Mozambique, 20 October 2026 MOZAMBIQUE

  Summarised under Strategies, plans and policies.

Data protection

- **Nigeria Data Protection Commission hosts Sri Lankan delegation for study tour** — Tech Review Africa, 20 October 2026 NIGERIA

  Nigeria's Data Protection Commission hosted a delegation from Sri Lanka's Data Protection Authority for a two-day study tour, reported on 20 October 2026. Sri Lanka is the eighteenth country to visit the Commission for knowledge exchange, and the World Bank supported the visit. National Commissioner Vincent Olatunji presented the Commission's roadmap and its public-private partnership model.

- **Legal Aid SA resets all passwords after phishing attack** — ITWeb South Africa, 20 October 2026 SOUTH AFRICA

  Legal Aid South Africa ordered a password reset for all staff and compulsory cyber-security training after phishing e-mails posing as National Prosecuting Authority summonses circulated around 8 and 9 October 2026. It said it knew of no successful breach, and the Information Regulator said it had received no security-compromise notification. This was reported on 20 October 2026. *Also under Cybersecurity.*

- **Data Protection Commission warns against exposure of evacuated Ghanaians' personal information** — Adomonline.com, 20 October 2026 GHANA

  Ghana's Data Protection Commission said, in a statement reported on 20 October 2026, that publishing the names, signatures and financial-assistance records of 1,964 Ghanaians evacuated from South Africa exposed them to identity theft and fraud. It told the Minority Caucus, the Foreign Affairs Ministry and media houses that registering as data controllers does not exempt them from the Data Protection Act. It urged redaction and announced a review of the legal basis for the disclosures.

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Regional collaboration

- **Gabon/Télécommunications : l'ARTAC engage à Libreville la révision de ses textes fondateurs** — Agence Gabonaise de Presse, 20 October 2026 CENTRAL AFRICA

  The Central African telecoms regulators' assembly ARTAC opened its 4th extraordinary session in Libreville on 20 October 2026, running two days and hosted by Gabon's ARCEP. Digital Economy Minister Mark-Alexandre Doumba launched it. Participants are reviewing ARTAC's statutes, rules of procedure and financial regulations, and São Tomé and Príncipe's regulator formally presented its membership application.

- **Gabon/ARTAC : six groupes de travail permanents créés pour harmoniser la réglementation en Afrique centrale** — Agence Gabonaise de Presse, 20 October 2026 CENTRAL AFRICA

  ARTAC created six permanent technical working groups at its 4th extraordinary Conference of Regulators session in Libreville on 20 October 2026. They cover radiocommunications, technical standards on safety and environmental protection, regulatory governance, postal regulation, digital financial services and consumer protection. The session, hosted by ARCEP Gabon, is also reviewing ARTAC's statutes, rules of procedure and financial regulations. *Also under Standards.*

- **Burkina Faso : Les régulateurs du numérique de l'UEMOA réunis à Ouagadougou pour renforcer leur coopération** — leFaso.net, 20 October 2026 WEST AFRICA

  The second session of the UEMOA national digital regulators' committee (CRNN) opened in Ouagadougou on 20 October 2026 and runs until 22 October. The agenda covers regulation of digital financial services, sharing of telecoms infrastructure and community roaming. Burkina Faso currently chairs the committee, and the first session was held in Cotonou from 28 to 31 October 2025. *Also under Digital Payments and Fintech and Connectivity.*

- **Benin, Ghana and Rwanda Take Major Step Towards Africa's Single Digital Market Through Cross-Border Digital Identity Interoperability** — Smart Africa, 20 October 2026 BENIN GHANA RWANDA AFRICA

  Benin, Ghana and Rwanda completed Phase 1 of the Smart Africa Data Exchange cross-border digital identity pilot, announced on 20 October 2026. The three national systems were connected and verified identities end to end using synthetic data. Phase 2 prepares a controlled operational pilot for border identity checks, subject to national approvals and security assessments. *Also under Digital Identity and CRVS and Data Exchange.*

- **Afrique centrale : l'ARTAC veut harmoniser les règles du jeu numérique** — GabonReview, 20 October 2026 CENTRAL AFRICA

  Central African telecoms regulators are meeting in Libreville on 20 and 21 October 2026 to revise the founding texts of ARTAC. Minister Mark-Alexandre Doumba opened the 4th extraordinary session on 20 October. Delegations from DR Congo, Congo, Cameroon, Chad, Equatorial Guinea, the Central African Republic and São Tomé and Príncipe are reviewing revised statutes, rules of procedure and financial regulations. *Also under Connectivity.*

Standards

- **NCC device verification questions Nigeria's phone imports** — TechCabal, 20 October 2026 NIGERIA

Nigeria's Communications Commission launched a Device Checker on 7 October 2026 that lets buyers dial *315# to see whether a phone is type approved, using its IMEI. An article on 20 October 2026 notes that 99% of smartphones are imported and about 63 million devices are sold each year, and questions how well the NCC can enforce compliance. Buyers of flagged phones have no standard refund route.* Also under Access to services.*

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Public debate and participation in policymaking

- **TikTok launches election centre ahead of SA local govt polls** — ITWeb South Africa, 20 October 2026 SOUTH AFRICA

  TikTok announced on 20 October 2026 an in-app election centre built with the Electoral Commission of South Africa for the 4 November 2026 local government elections. It links to an AI media-literacy hub. TikTok said it removed about 90,000 South African videos between January and March 2026 for civic-integrity, misinformation and misleading AI-content violations. *Also under AI.*

- **Ramaphosa to meet Silicon Valley AI giants as South Africa eyes tech future** — The Citizen, 20 October 2026 SOUTH AFRICA

  President Cyril Ramaphosa said at the Black Wednesday commemoration lunch on Monday 19 October 2026 that he will lead a delegation to Silicon Valley after the local government elections. It will include people from government, universities, business and youth, to meet AI company leaders and learn how the technology works. No travel dates were given. *Also under AI and US / hyperscaler activities.*

- **ISPA urges free data for poor households** — ITWeb South Africa, 20 October 2026 SOUTH AFRICA

  South Africa's Internet Service Providers' Association called on 20 October 2026 for a free basic data allowance for people below the poverty line. It said the communications department has listed a cost-to-communicate programme for years without a substantive plan. It also said the Competition Commission's proposed Electronic Communications Act amendments are unlikely to be finalised before the end of 2027. *Also under Digital divides and Connectivity.*

- **IEC receives over 700 election misinformation complaints, enlists Google, Meta and TikTok ahead of November vote** — The Citizen, 20 October 2026 SOUTH AFRICA

  South Africa's Electoral Commission said on 20 October 2026 that it has received more than 700 election-misinformation complaints, most about posts on X, ahead of the 4 November 2026 local government elections. It is working with Google, Meta, Microsoft, TikTok and Moxii Africa against disinformation. Electoral Code breaches carry fines up to R200,000 or five to ten years' imprisonment. *Also under AI.*

- **Borrowed trust: Africa and algorithms** — Wits University, 20 October 2026 SOUTH AFRICA AFRICA

  The University of the Witwatersrand published a research feature on 20 October 2026 featuring Professor Keith Breckenridge of WiSER. It considers whether digital finance tools such as biometric IDs, automated credit scoring and asset registers will reduce Africa's credit exclusion or deepen it, and which institutions of trust would be needed. No figures were given. *Also under Digital Identity and CRVS and Digital Payments and Fintech.*

Finance

New investments

- **Vodacom — Mpumalanga network capital expenditure, 2026** — Vodacom, 20 October 2026 SOUTH AFRICA

  Vodacom announced on 20 October 2026 that it will spend more than R600 million of its own funds on network infrastructure in Mpumalanga in the current financial year. It invested R620 million there in 2025/26, and the spending covers all 17 local municipalities. *Also under Connectivity*.

ICT Infrastructure

Connectivity

- **Vodacom South Africa Invests R600 Million to Expand Connectivity in Mpumalanga** — Tech Africa News, 20 October 2026 SOUTH AFRICA

  Vodacom said on 20 October 2026 that it is investing more than R600 million in Mpumalanga network infrastructure this financial year, after R620 million in 2025/26. Its sites in the province have grown from just over 1,300 to 1,408, and the share connected by fibre from 41% to 45%. *Also under Access to services*.

- **NITDA Moves to Boost Digital Public Services as MDAs Begin IPv6 Migration Training** — Techeconomy, 20 October 2026 NIGERIA

  Nigeria's NITDA began its first IPv6 migration readiness training for federal ministries, departments and agencies, with AFRINIC and the Nigeria IPv6 Council, as reported on 20 October 2026. It runs in two streams, for management and for technical staff, and NITDA is funding certification for the technical staff. The move is tied to online public services and the National Sovereign Cloud Initiative. *Also under Training and skills and Other GovTech and e-Gov*.

- **NIGCOMSAT CEO highlights impact of Nigeria's first NUCAP base station on rural connectivity** — Tech Review Africa, 20 October 2026 NIGERIA

  NIGCOMSAT chief executive Jane Egerton-Idehen, with Minister Bosun Tijani and others, visited Nigeria's first NUCAP base station in Bende, Abia State, as reported on 20 October 2026. The solar-powered 45-metre station covers a radius of about eight kilometres and is expected to serve the community school and hospital. NUCAP plans 3,700 base stations in total. *Also under Digital divides*.

- **Medusa Submarine Cable System Completes Shore-End Installation in Libya** — Tech Africa News, 20 October 2026 LIBYA

  The Medusa submarine cable system completed its Pre-Laid Shore End installation in Benghazi, Libya, as reported on 20 October 2026. This is the pre-installed cable section between the landing site and the offshore connection point. No value or completion date was given.

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Data Storage

- **Liberia to Digitalize 16 Key Government Services with World Bank Support** — FrontPage Africa, 20 October 2026 LIBERIA

  Liberia's Office of the Chief Information Officer met ministries and agencies on 17 and 18 October 2026 to validate 16 priority government services for digitalisation with World Bank support. They assessed readiness and procurement for an e-Liberia one-stop portal, a Government Service Bus for real-time data sharing, National Data Center upgrades and digitised County Service Centers. *Also under Other GovTech and e-Gov and Data Exchange.*

Cybersecurity

- **Zim strengthens digital risk management systems** — ITWeb Africa, 20 October 2026 ZIMBABWE

  Zimbabwe's ICT ministry told its departments to submit validated risk registers by 6 November 2026 and to include risk assessments in every new major project proposal from now on. The instructions came out of an enterprise risk-management workshop the minister opened in Harare on 19 October 2026. *Also under Other GovTech and e-Gov.*

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Digital Payments and Fintech

- **Stanbic Ghana explores stablecoin trade settlement** — ITWeb Africa, 20 October 2026 GHANA

  Stanbic Bank Ghana and Hong Kong-based RD Technologies said, as reported on 20 October 2026, that they are exploring a stablecoin-backed cross-border settlement service for Ghanaian importers paying Asian suppliers. Stanbic would handle onboarding, KYC and local-currency settlement, and RD Technologies the digital-asset rails. Next steps are regulatory engagement, technical validation and a controlled pilot, all subject to regulatory no-objection.

- **Postbank full-service banking licence still miles off** — ITWeb South Africa, 20 October 2026 SOUTH AFRICA

  Communications Minister Solly Malatsi told Parliament, as reported on 20 October 2026, that South Africa's Postbank has been directed to submit a new application to establish a bank under section 12 of the Banks Act and has not yet done so. Outstanding items are recapitalisation, which is with National Treasury, banking-system modernisation and a Bank Controlling Company. Postbank paid social grants to about 1.9 million beneficiaries in September 2026. *Also under Access to services.*

- **Orange Egypt Partners With Botim to Enable UAE-to-Egypt Remittances** — Tech Africa News, 20 October 2026 EGYPT

  Orange Egypt and the UAE fintech Botim announced on 20 October 2026 a UAE-to-Egypt remittance route that pays directly into Orange Cash wallets. It is Botim's first partnership with an Egyptian mobile operator. Botim has more than 2 million Egyptian users and Orange Cash about 10 million.

- **Burkina Faso : Les régulateurs du numérique de l'UEMOA réunis à Ouagadougou pour renforcer leur coopération** — leFaso.net, 20 October 2026 WEST AFRICA

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Technology

AI

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Capacity

Training and skills

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Inclusion

Access to services

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Data

Use of satellite data

- **Données, modélisation & géomatique - ONACC** — Observatoire National sur les Changements Climatiques (ONACC), 20 October 2026 CAMEROON

  Cameroon's national climate observatory ONACC lists a library of 11 data, modelling and geomatics products on its website, seen on 20 October 2026. They include a national climate and geospatial database on PostgreSQL/PostGIS, risk maps, Sentinel satellite imagery, drought indices and web services. The page says connection to the database tables will be added later.

- **Bulletin agrométéorologique décadaire** — Agence Nationale de la Météorologie du Burkina Faso (ANAM), Météo Burkina, 20 October 2026 BURKINA FASO

  Météo Burkina Faso publishes a ten-day agrometeorological bulletin covering rainfall, temperature and humidity anomalies and vegetation index data. The page seen on 20 October 2026 lists a latest update for 13 to 19 October 2026, describing monsoon winds with some harmattan incursions. Earlier updates cover periods back to early September 2026.

Geopolitics

US / hyperscaler activities

- **Ramaphosa to meet Silicon Valley AI giants as South Africa eyes tech future** — The Citizen, 20 October 2026 SOUTH AFRICA

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Digital sovereignty

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This bulletin is produced automatically at the end of each data collection sweep but only includes items published on the day cited in the edition, and the previous day. Items published in the last month can be found on the country pages. The links to all items stored in the corpus can be found in the catalogue.

Bulletins are kept for a week — the last week's editions are listed above, each at its own dated address — and are then deleted. Older material is in the country and region news.